

AHK ACADEMY

English Lesson – Common Idioms

Teacher: AHSAN

 Level: Intermediate – Upper Intermediate  Duration: 60 minutes

Introduction

Goal

Today, we will learn 22 common English idioms that make your English sound natural and fluent! By the end of the lesson, you'll understand their meanings and be able to use them confidently in your speech and writing.

≡ Idioms List with Meanings and Examples

No	Idiom	Meaning	Example Sentence
1	Break the ice	Start a friendly talk	I told a joke to break the ice.
2	Chill out	Relax or calm down	Just chill out, everything's fine.
3	Better late than never	Late is better than never	You finished it — better late than never!
4	Around the clock	All day and night	Doctors worked around the clock.
5	Keep an eye on	Watch carefully	Please keep an eye on my bag.
6	It slipped my mind	I forgot	Sorry, it slipped my mind to call you.
7	In the nick of time	Just in time	We arrived in the nick of time.
8	Spill the beans	Tell a secret	Come on, spill the beans!
9	Put yourself in someone's shoes	Imagine their situation	Put yourself in her shoes.
10	Tight on money	Have little money	I can't go out, I'm tight on money.
11	Cross your mind	Think of something	It never crossed my mind.
12	Cut corners	Do cheaply or lazily	Don't cut corners on this job.
13	Easier said than done	Harder to do	Quitting smoking is easier said than done.
14	Get cold feet	Become scared	He got cold feet before his speech.
15	Hang in there	Don't give up	Hang in there, you'll make it!
16	Break the bank	Cost too much	That phone will break the bank.
17	On fire	Doing very well	You're on fire today!
18	On the same page	Agree together	Let's make sure we're on the same page.
19	Call it a day	Stop working	Let's call it a day and rest.
20	Out of the blue	Suddenly	She called out of the blue.
21	Keep it to yourself	Don't tell anyone	Please keep it to yourself.
22	Speak of the devil	The person appears	Speak of the devil — here he is!

② Practice – Multiple Choice Questions

Choose the correct idiom

1. When the teacher told a joke, it helped to _____. a) cut cornersb) break the icec) get cold feet
2. Don't worry — just _____ and relax. a) hang in thereb) chill outc) spill the beans
3. He forgot my birthday; it just _____. a) slipped his mindb) crossed his mindc) called it a day
4. We finished the report _____. a) in the nick of timeb) around the clockc) on fire
5. Please _____ my bag while I go out. a) keep an eye onb) put yourself inc) call it a day
6. I finally finished reading — _____! a) better late than neverb) tight on moneyc) out of the blue
7. They worked _____ to fix the issue. a) around the clockb) on firec) break the bank
8. He told my secret — he _____! a) got cold feetb) spilled the beansc) cut corners
9. Before judging others, _____. a) chill outb) put yourself in their shoesc) call it a day
10. I can't go out — I'm _____. a) on fireb) tight on moneyc) breaking the bank

Speaking Practice – Fill in the Blanks Story

Use all 22 idioms to complete the story

Yesterday was one of the craziest days ever! When I joined the new office, everyone looked serious, so I decided to _____ (1) by telling a funny story. After that, people started to _____ (2) and relax.

My manager was late — _____ (3), he finally came! We had to work _____ (4) to finish a big project. He told me to _____ (5) the documents while he talked to the client.

I was supposed to send an email, but it _____ (6)! Luckily, I remembered _____ (7) and sent it just in time. Later, one coworker accidentally _____ (8) about the surprise party. I told him, “Next time, _____ (9)!”

My friend asked me for money, but I was _____ (10). He said I should _____ (11) and not stress too much. We agreed that healthy eating is _____ (12).

In the afternoon, I almost joined a contest, but I _____ (13). My boss told me to _____ (14). Later, we bought coffee that didn't _____ (15) — cheap and good! Everyone was _____ (16)!

Before leaving, we made sure we were _____ (17) about the next plan. Then my manager said, “Let's _____ (18)!” When I got home, a friend called me _____ (19)! I told him a secret but said, “_____ (20).”

He told me how he had to _____ (21) with two jobs. Just as I hung up, my roommate entered — _____ (22)!

Homework

Speaking Task: Record a 2-minute story using **all 22 idioms** naturally. Use this story as your guide or create your own version. Be expressive, confident, and clear!